10-mark Question Answers — Democracy: meaning, forms, characteristics, merits, demerits and preconditions

Introduction to Political Theory · Unit 2 · Chapter Democracy: meaning, forms, characteristics, merits, demerits and preconditions

Assam University · BA FYUGP / NEP 2020 · Semester 1

10-mark Model Answer Framework

Model question: Discuss Democracy: meaning, forms, characteristics, merits, demerits and preconditions.

Introduction: Define the concept and explain why it matters in political theory or Indian government and politics.

Main discussion: Organise the answer under clear headings. Explain the meaning, context, features, types, institutions or arguments relevant to the question. Each point should include an explanation rather than a bare list.

Examples and critical analysis: Add relevant examples, constitutional provisions or political thinkers only where they directly support the argument. Consider limitations, counterarguments or implementation challenges.

Conclusion: Summarise the main argument and give a balanced judgement that answers the question.

Additional examination practice

• Define democracy and distinguish direct from representative democracy.

• State two merits and two limitations of democracy.

• Explain the conditions that help democracy function effectively.

Answer-writing checklist

Definition and context · 3–5 organised points · relevant examples · critical assessment · direct conclusion.